which, according to the British, lay eighteen or so miles inside Sikkim. After failing to persuade the Tibetans to leave, a British expeditionary force under Brigadier General Thomas Graham advanced on Lingtu and expelled the Tibetans, although the Tibetans made further efforts to reclaim this area. [1]

When, therefore, in 1889, the Chinese Imperial Envoy (known as Amban) in Lhasa proposed an agreement with the British on the Tibet–Sikkim frontier, the British and Chinese empires negotiated and signed the Convention between Great Britain and China Relating to Sikkim and Tibet, in Calcutta (Kolkata) on 17 March 1890. By signing such a treaty, the Chinese Empire accepted that Sikkim belonged to the British sphere of influence. The Tibetans claimed that they were not part of these negotiations and neither did they acquiesce to this Convention, nor to the subsequent Trade Regulations signed on 5 December 1893, which opened the Chumbi Valley to trade for all British subjects from 1 May 1894. The Tibetans continued to view Sikkim as subordinate to Lhasa, and used every opportunity to demonstrate their control, including by reoccupying some places in north-east Sikkim that the 1890 Convention had placed within the Sikkim territory, and by demolishing border pillars that the British had tried to erect on the boundary. In 1895, after the Tibetans demolished a pillar at Jelep La, the Government of Bengal informed the Secretary of State for India in London that it was abandoning its efforts to demarcate the boundary. No further effort was made by the British Indian Government to demarcate the Tibet-Sikkim boundary on the ground.

In 1904, weary of Tibetan intransigence in accepting the boundary and trading arrangements negotiated between the British and the Chinese, the Government of India sent Sir Francis Younghusband with a military force into Lhasa. The resultant convention between Great Britain and Tibet (known